Young kids, grandparents, and everyone in between

The goal of game night is not a winner. It's a table where everybody wants to come back next week.

For the youngest players

- Deal them in - never 'help them watch'. Kids who hold cards are players.
- Narrate the tricky bits: 'This card means the suit changes. Which suit do you like?'
- Let them win sometimes on purpose, and lose sometimes on purpose. Both teach something.
- Give them a job when attention runs out: scorekeeper, chip mover, official card-shuffler.
- Round lengths matter more than rules. Two short hands beat one long epic.

For grandparents

- Ask them to teach a game from their own childhood. Elders become the experts, not guests.
- Big-print score sheets and a brighter lamp. Eyes tire before enthusiasm does.
- Trade vigorous games (Snap!) for memory games (Go Fish, Old Maid) if hands or reflexes prefer it.
- Invite stories between hands. The story of the 1974 family tournament is part of the game.

For the whole table

- Read the house-rule cards together before round one. Rules everyone helped pick are rules everyone can live with.
- Celebrate the best loss of the night. 'You drew the exact card you needed and everyone saw it!' is a trophy too.
- Never rank the players out loud. Scores stay on the sheet, love stays on the table.
- Rotate a 'table captain' each week who picks the first game. Power is a snack too.
- End while it's still fun. A night people don't want to finish is the highest compliment.

A friendly note from Asdale Dynamics, LLC: these pages are written the way we'd explain them to a friend - plainly, warmly, and with zero judgment. If a rule doesn't fit your table, change it. It's your table.